MONTHLY UPDATE

Cape Verde: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

PRIORITIES FOR THE UNITED NATIONS PARTNERSHIP CYCLE

- **Governo prioriza modernização do Estado, ação climática e juventude na parceria com a ONU** — Expresso das Ilhas, 10 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's prime minister named state modernisation and digital transformation, alongside climate action, decentralisation and youth opportunity, as the government's priorities for the new phase of its United Nations partnership, at a high-level meeting with the country team in Praia.

MAIO TRANSFORMA ISLAND TRANSFORMATION PROGRAMME

- **Maio: Governo apresenta programa "Maio Transforma" para acelerar economia e transformação digital da ilha** — Inforpress, 16 September 2026

Cabo Verde's economy and digital transition ministry presented 'Maio Transforma' on the island of Maio on 16 September 2026, a programme within the national 'Cabo Verde Transforma' pilot to develop farming, fishing, enterprise and the digital economy. Minister António Baptista said projects on internet access and training would start within days. No budget is given.

Data protection

DELEGATION OF POWERS OVER THE INTELLIGENCE SERVICE

- **Serviço de Informações da República: Entre a defesa do Estado e os limites da democracia** — A Nacao, 8 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's prime minister delegated coordination of the intelligence service SIR to the interior minister by despacho no. 15/2026 in the Boletim Oficial. The opposition MpD calls it unconstitutional, arguing the SIR law gives the prime minister exclusive authority, and says it will challenge it. The government cites its general power of delegation; President José Maria Neves declined to comment publicly.

Finance

New investments

DIGITAL CABO VERDE PROJECT

- **UGPE — Digital Cabo Verde project mission review: 80%/40% disbursement, school connectivity priority** — UGPE (Unidade de Gestão de Projetos Especiais), Cabo Verde, 24 September 2026

  A World Bank mission reviewed the Digital Cabo Verde project between 22 and 26 September, reporting about 80% disbursement of the original US$20 million financing (2020-2025) and about 40% of the US$20 million additional financing (2025-2028). School connectivity was named the priority for the additional financing, with stronger coordination across ministries and a clearer role for the DGTED.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SOUTH ATLANTIC INTERCONNECTION CORRIDOR (DE-CIX AND CVTELECOM)

- **DE-CIX and Cabo Verde Telecom Plan New South Atlantic Interconnection Corridor** — DE-CIX, 29 September 2026

  DE-CIX and Cabo Verde Telecom signed a non-binding letter of intent to explore a Lisbon to Sao Paulo interconnection corridor, the operator supplying transport capacity in return for access to DE-CIX exchanges. Terms await a definitive agreement.

Cybersecurity

IMPERSONATION PHISHING AGAINST THE POSTAL OPERATOR

- **Correios de Cabo Verde alertam para mensagens fraudulentas** — Expresso das Ilhas, 8 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's postal operator, Correios de Cabo Verde, warned on 8 September 2026 that people impersonating its staff are sending messages asking recipients to click a link named 'Correios.ink/cv'. The operator said the link is not its own and advised the public not to click it or share personal or banking details.

DPI

Data Exchange

DIGITAL-NOMAD STATISTICS AND DATA MODULE IN SGIT

- **Cabo Verde — AfDB-financed REOI for SGIT digital-nomads statistics and interoperability module, Morabeza Innovation Project** — Centro de Coordenação Integrada de Projetos (CCIP) / UGPE, Governo de Cabo Verde, 21 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's integrated project coordination centre, CCIP, invited expressions of interest on 21 September 2026 from firms to build a statistics and data module for the National Digital Nomads Programme within the SGIT system, interoperable with other state platforms. The 12-month contract is financed from an African Development Bank credit to the Morabeza Innovation Project. No contract value is given.

Digital Payments and Fintech

REDE VINTI4 NATIONAL RETAIL PAYMENT SWITCH

- **Quase 5 milhões de operações na rede Vinti4 em Agosto** — Expresso das Ilhas, 14 September 2026

  The Banco de Cabo Verde reported on 14 September 2026 that residents made 4,992,880 operations worth 21,159.9 million escudos on the vinti4 card network in August, down 0.3% in number and 2.4% in value on July. Card purchases made up 3,768,595 operations. The interbank clearing system processed 131,456 operations worth 25,543.1 million escudos, down 19.1% in number.

Registries

CADASTRO SOCIAL UNICO (CSU)

- **Governo de Cabo Verde e Organizacao das Nacoes Unidas (ONU) iniciam a discussao de alinhamento e cooperacao para os proximos anos** — Governo de Cabo Verde (via Africa Newsroom / APO Group), 10 September 2026

  At a high-level meeting between Cabo Verde's government and the United Nations in Praia on 10 September 2026, the UN country team reported that the Cadastro Social Único, the national social registry, covers 64 per cent of the population. UN Resident Coordinator Patrícia Portela de Sousa said the next cooperation framework, for 2028–2032, will follow the new National Development Plan.

Sectoral management information systems

NATIONAL HEALTH SYSTEM DIGITALISATION

- **Contratação de Empresa de Consultoria para Formação, Implementação e Apoio à Utilização de Ferramentas Digitais de Saúde (SIS/PORTAL e DHIS2)** — Centro de Coordenação Integrada de Projetos (CCIP), Ministério da Coordenação de Projetos Especiais e Acesso a Fundos, Cabo Verde, 4 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's project coordination centre (CCIP) invited consultancy firms on 4 September 2026 to express interest in training health workers and managers on the SIS/Portal health information system and DHIS2. The six-month contract is funded from a USD 29 million IDA credit for the World Bank's West and Central Africa health security programme. Expressions of interest were due on 18 September.

SISTEMA DE INFORMACAO DA JUSTICA, CRIMINAL-PROCESS COMPONENT

- **Justica digital ja poupa 2,3 milhoes de folhas de papel** — Expresso das Ilhas, 17 September 2026

> A second evaluation of Cabo Verde's justice information system reports 46,000 criminal case files handled digitally across all 17 comarcas and an estimated 2.3 million sheets of paper saved over the 2025/2026 judicial year. It records 95.5 per cent of respondents using the system daily or several times a week, 401 professionals holding qualified digital signatures and 110 judges, prosecutors and court officers trained in artificial intelligence, with civil-process pilots awaiting authorisation.

Technology

Innovation ecosystem

ARQUIPELAGO DIGITAL TELEPORT COMPANY HUB

- **Brasil e Portugal querem reforçar negócios com Cabo Verde e apostar no mercado africano** — Observador (Agência Lusa), 4 September 2026

  Brazilian and Portuguese business leaders at a Brazil–Cabo Verde–Portugal business forum in Praia on 4 September 2026 described Cabo Verde as a base for trade with West Africa. Gildo Batista of Brazil's Grupo Teletur said the Teleport digital hub, meant to attract technology companies and remote workers, would open the following week. No investment figure is given.

- **Missão Cabo Verde Teleport supera metas previstas e prepara novos investimentos no país** — Inforpress, 17 September 2026

  Grupo Teleport's president, Gildo Baptista, said on 17 September 2026 that its fourth mission to Cabo Verde, which included the five-day second Brazil-Cabo Verde Forum in Praia, exceeded its targets for contracts and partnerships. The group created Arquipélago Digital Teleport, a company hub for the country's technology park. No investment amounts are given.

Capacity

Literacy

NATIONAL DIGITAL LITERACY PROGRAMME AND SKILLS RATE

- **Uni-CV assinala Dia Mundial dos Correios com debate sobre comércio eletrónico** — Universidade de Cabo Verde, 9 October 2026

  Cabo Verde's economy and digital transition minister, António Baptista, said at a University of Cabo Verde debate on e-commerce in Praia on 9 October 2026 that his ministry will run four national programmes, including digital and financial literacy. He said the Carteira Digital and 5G are in testing and a single government portal is in preparation.

Inclusion

Digital divides

BENDI MAX DIGITAL INCLUSION PILOT FOR WOMEN TRADERS

- **Maio: Projecto 'Bendi Max' arranca em Outubro para reforçar inclusão digital de mulheres comerciantes** — Inforpress, 19 September 2026

  Bendi Max, a pilot to train 250 women traders in Cabo Verde to use digital tools in their businesses, starts on Maio island in October 2026 with 30 participants, Inforpress reported on 19 September. It then extends to Fogo, Santiago and São Vicente, with the economy ministry, Pró-Empresa, Cabo Verde Digital and the United Nations as partners.

Data

Open data

FISHERIES INFORMATION SYSTEM (FIS)

- **Cabo Verde destaca avanços na transparência das pescas em evento internacional da FiTI na FAO** — Ministério de Agricultura e Ambiente (Cabo Verde), 10 September 2026

  Cabo Verde presented its fisheries transparency work at a Fisheries Transparency Initiative (FiTI) session during the 37th meeting of the FAO Committee on Fisheries in Rome. The country joined the FiTI Standard in 2023 and has set up a public Fisheries Information System publishing data on licences, landings, catches, revenue, subsidies and the legal framework.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

THIRD MILLENNIUM CHALLENGE COMPACT

- **Millennium Challenge Corporation - Cabo Verde elegível, mas ainda não se sabe se vai avançar com candidatura** — Expresso das Ilhas, 12 September 2026

  Cabo Verde is among 42 countries listed as candidates for a new Millennium Challenge Corporation compact in the US agency's fiscal year 2027 report, published at the end of August 2026. The country has completed two compacts and had a third cancelled. Cabo Verde's ministry for special projects and fund access did not say whether it will apply.

EU activities

EU SPECIAL PARTNERSHIP DIGITAL PILLAR AND GLOBAL GATEWAY PACKAGE

- **Joint Communique: Fourteenth Ministerial Meeting European Union (EU) – Cabo Verde Special Partnership** — European External Action Service, 9 October 2026

  The 14th ministerial meeting of the EU–Cabo Verde Special Partnership, held in Brussels on 9 October 2026, reported Global Gateway digital projects in preparation: domestic and international submarine cables, better connections between the islands and access to European digital infrastructure. It also noted progress in EU support for Cabo Verde's national data and AI strategies. No amounts are given.

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